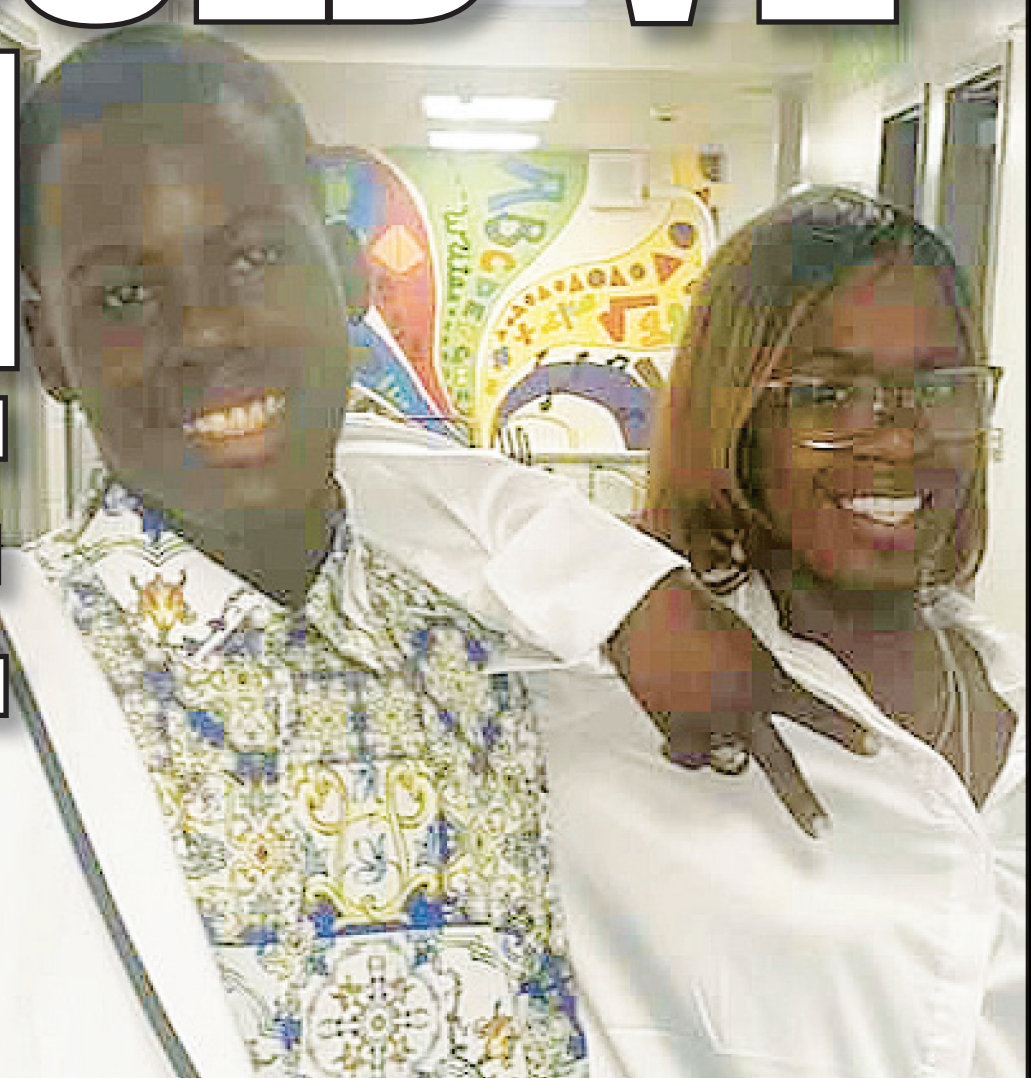


DAILY NEWS

NEW YORK'S HOMETOWN NEWSPAPER

'I WOULD'VE BEEN ABLE TO SAVE HIM'



Audley Sykes, 17 (left) got caught in a rip tide at Rockaway Beach and drowned. His mom, Patrice Thompson, said she would have been able to save him if she had been there. PHOTO COURTESY OF FAMILY

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**Mom of Queens teen who drowned at Rockaway Beach
had been teaching him to swim in months before he died**